

When the spreadsheet works— but the workflow around it does not

The Sheet may hold the right facts while recurring decisions still depend on manual filtering, counting, and rewriting.

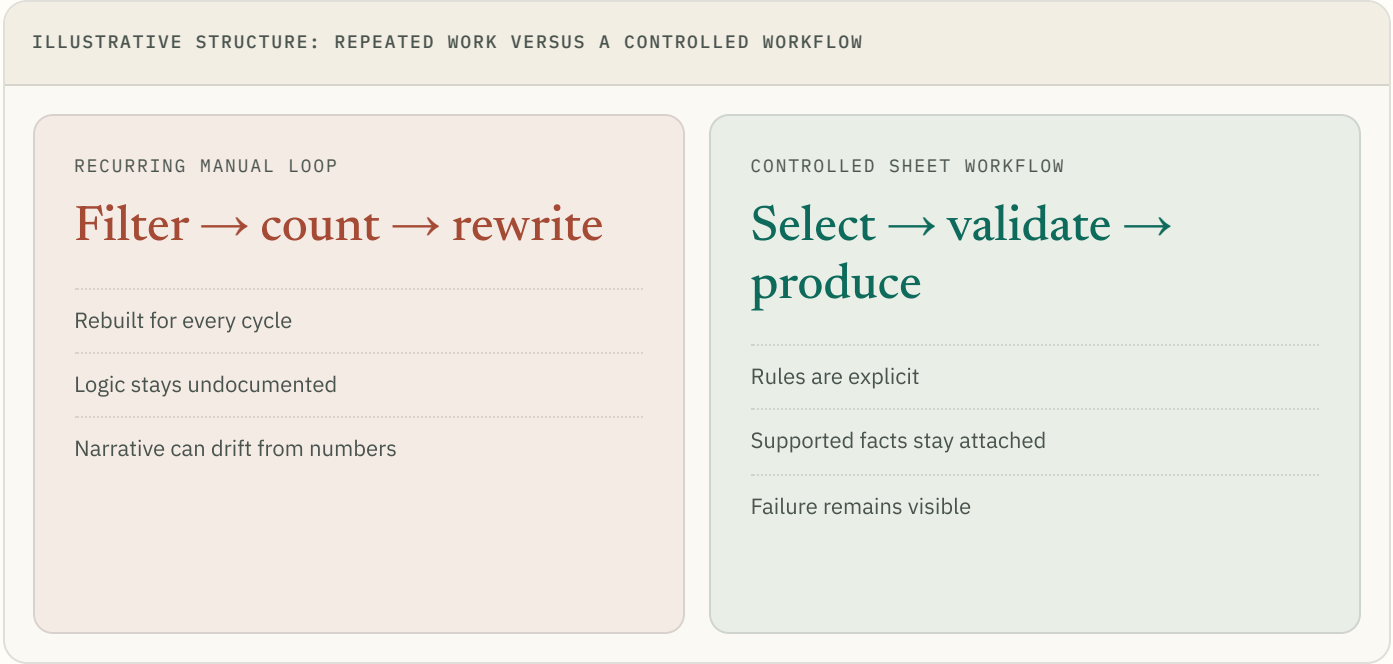
- 01

The source data can already be current.
- 02

Each decision rebuilds filters, counts, and wording.
- 03

Numbers and narrative gain room to drift.

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A working example I built: one Sheet, three controlled workflows

This self-built sample shows the pattern running. It is evidence of the method—not client work or a standalone product.

- 01

Built by me on a sample tracker.

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- 02

One dialog drives three reporting jobs.
- 03

Every run requires explicit choices before writing.

WORKING APPS SCRIPT DEMONSTRATION

PM Report Builder

GOOGLE APPS SCRIPT

Build the PM view you need

Choose a deterministic operational report or an AI-assisted stakeholder draft.

Frozen snapshot · 2026-07-25 · Source workbook preserved unchanged

Report

Stakeholder update

Project

Project Aurora

AI provider

Claude · claude-sonnet-5

AI-assisted draft — review before sharing. Claude and OpenAI keys stay in Secret Manager; Gemini uses owner-authorized Vertex AI.

Preview scope

Generate report

Self-built demonstration using sample data. The dialog requires explicit choices before creating an owner-private draft.

Sample data

Explicit choices

Not client work

The pattern transfers: structured fields, Apps Script logic, governed AI

The example works because three layers have separate jobs—and the same architecture can support other Sheet-based decisions.

- 01

Controlled fields keep
source facts trustworthy.

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- 02

Apps Script owns
calculations and writes.
- 03

AI helps with language,
never arithmetic.

STRUCTURED SOURCE FIELDS IN THE EXAMPLE

	A	B	C	D	E	
1	Task Tracker					
2	Formula-driven timing, recommended actions, validation, and semantic condition					
3						
4						
5	Edit task inputs in columns A:H and K:M. Columns I, J, and L calculate automatically through row 205.					
6	Completed		Overdue		Due To	
7	Task ID	Task	Project	Owner	Priority	
8	TSK-1001	Approve refreshed homepage	Website Refresh	▼ Avery Chen	▼ High	▼ Co
9	TSK-1002	Repair mobile navigation	Website Refresh	▼ Jordan Brooks	▼ Critical	▼ In f
10	TSK-1003	Publish redirect map	Website Refresh	▼ Avery Chen	▼ High	▼ In f
11	TSK-1004	Archive stale CRM contacts	CRM Cleanup	▼ Jordan Brooks	▼ Medium	▼ In f

The screenshot is one example; the transferable pattern is controlled data, deterministic logic, and governed language generation.

Structured fields

Apps Script logic

Governed AI

Start with one decision, then map data and acceptance checks

A bounded build begins with the recurring decision, the fields that support it, and the conditions required for trust.

01

Pick one recurring, high-friction decision.

02

Map supporting fields and missing data.

03

Agree acceptance checks before any build.

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A BOUNDED ENGAGEMENT STARTS BEFORE CODE

1

Choose

Name one recurring decision worth simplifying.

2

Map

Connect that decision to real fields and gaps.

3

Check

Define what must be true before output is trusted.

Back to the example: useful output without invented precision

The workload report uses only counts the sample Sheet supports and remains useful with AI completely switched off.

- 01
Use open, overdue, blocked, and due-soon counts.
- 02
Do not invent utilization without hours.
- 03
Keep deterministic output independent of AI.

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WORKLOAD EVIDENCE FROM THE SAMPLE BUILD

Grouped by	Worker							
Group	Open	Overdue	Due today	Blocked	Due soon	No due date	Task IDs	
Jordan Brooks	4	1	0	2	1	0	TSK-1002, TSK-1004, TSK-1010, TSK-1016	
Riley Patel	3	0	0	1	2	0	TSK-1006, TSK-1010, TSK-1017	
Avery Chen	2	0	1	0	0	1	TSK-1003, TSK-1008	
Morgan Lee	2	0	0	0	2	0	TSK-1007, TSK-1013	

The example reports open, overdue, blocked, and due-soon counts. It does not claim capacity or utilization the source data cannot support.

Supported countsNo false precisionAI optional

AI drafts language. Deterministic logic owns the numbers.

The boundary is enforced in code: scoped facts go out, supported figures come back, and validation failure stays visible.

- 01

Send selected facts, never notes or emails.
- 02

Check drafts against source IDs and figures.
- 03

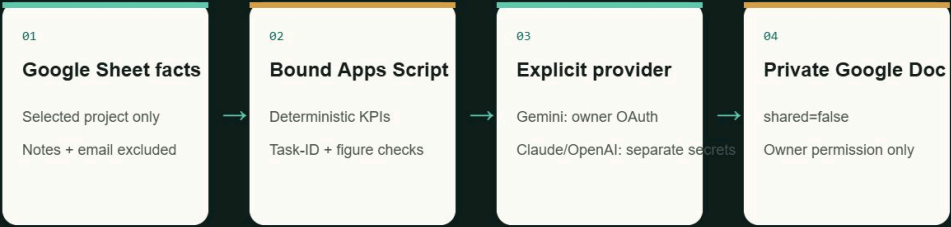
Preserve verified metrics when narrative validation fails.

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REDACTED SECURITY ARCHITECTURE

Selected facts move through one controlled reporting path.

Provider access stays server-side; every generated Doc is verified owner-private.



LIVE PROOF: TWO SECRET RESOURCES · SECRET ACCESSOR ROLE · VERIFIED DOC OWNER-ONLY

No API key, OAuth token, email address, private Sheet ID, or private Script ID is shown.

The still carries the argument immediately; the muted recording provides secondary execution proof.

- Scoped facts only
- Figures validated
- Failure stays visible

Build the smallest useful system inside tools you already use

The offer is one bounded workflow inside Google Workspace, with agreed checks, documentation, and a maintainable handover.

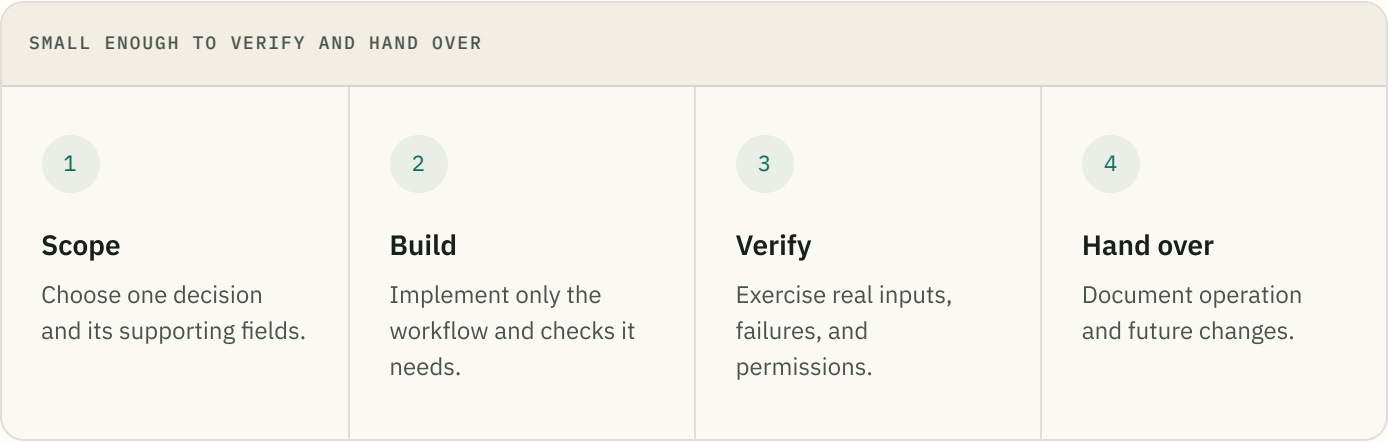
- 01

One workflow with bounded scope and checks.
- 02

No migration away from Google Workspace.
- 03

Keep a system your team can change.

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NEXT STEP

Show me the Sheet process you still run by hand

The next useful step is naming one recurring process—not scoping an entire platform or project.

- 01
Name one process you would stop doing manually.
- 02
Bring the Sheet as it is today.
- 03
Use the contact option shown.

NEXT STEP

Have a similar workflow?

Use my Upwork profile to message me about the workflow you want simplified.

[View Mike Lottridge on Upwork](#)

► [Read transcript](#)

ONE LOW-RISK NEXT STEP

1

Name it

Identify the recurring manual process.

2

Bring it

Use the Sheet as it exists today.

3

Check fit

Confirm the data, decision, and smallest useful scope.